

# Ian Cowpar

Senior Product Manager · Onboarding & Activation · Agentic AI · B2B Workforce SaaS

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## SUMMARY

Senior product manager who builds onboarding and activation systems that turn the first 90 days from a failure surface into a retention lever. A decade leading 40+ enterprise SaaS client onboardings end-to-end at Broadridge in compliance-grade financial services, where a wrong output had regulatory consequence rather than a care ticket. Two years at UKG owning AI capability platform work, including the organization's first organized AI capability layer (built from zero across 20 PMs without a top-down mandate) and shipping agentic AI as a first-class product feature inside a workforce-management platform. Originator of the Zero-Translation Building framework, with weekly published thought leadership on AI adoption realism and what activation actually compounds into.

## SELECTED OUTCOMES

- **Led 40+ enterprise SaaS client onboardings end-to-end** from contract through first successful production run in a regulated financial services environment, where a wrong output had regulatory consequence rather than a care ticket. Translated complex compliance capabilities into workflows non-technical buyers could operate without support, owning the activation arc that determined whether customers stayed and grew.
- **Built UKG product organization's first organized AI capability layer from zero**, scaling shared infrastructure across 20 PMs with no top-down mandate. Multiple PMs built their own agentic workflows and retired manual processes entirely. Adoption measured by what stopped, not what launched — extinction over addition.
- **Shipped agentic AI as a first-class product feature**, embedding a Claude Code function as the routing layer inside an opinionated analytics product that surfaced the single highest-leverage action across five issue panels spanning customer escalations, code defects, internal bugs, CVEs, and noise. Cut a working defect list ~97%.
- **Surfaced ~\$50M in at-risk ARR before escalation** through a composite risk model scoring top accounts on exposure, case volume, true-defect rate, and sentiment, replacing raw ticket counts with weighted signal and an automated weekly cadence the program lead acted on.
- **Drove cross-functional prioritization across product, engineering, and services without direct authority**, translating customer signal from executive escalation rooms into tradeoff decisions across four product lines on a \$250M ARR platform serving 300 customers.

## EXPERIENCE

**Senior Product Manager** · UKG · Lowell, MA · Jun 2024 – Apr 2026

*Senior product ownership across AI capability, agentic workflows, and data products serving 300 enterprise customers on a \$250M ARR workforce-management platform.*

- **Built the organization's first AI capability platform from zero**, scaling across 20 PMs without top-down mandate. Multiple PMs developed their own agentic workflows and retired manual workflows entirely.
- **Shipped agentic AI inside a product** by embedding a Claude Code function as the routing layer in a five-panel analytics product, cutting a working defect list ~97%.
- **Shipped a zero-to-one self-serve product concept-to-production in one week**, prototyped in Claude Code and scoped with the platform architect, projected to cut ~30% from a ticket-gated enterprise workflow.
- **Owned the upgrade program's data products** — a composite ARR-risk model that surfaced ~\$50M at risk before escalation, and an opinionated analytics product driving prioritization across

four product lines.

*Drove cross-functional prioritization in executive escalation rooms. Brand Champion, UKG North America Regional Lead 2026; Fire Up ERG (women and allies), Business Innovation workstream lead.*

**Business Analyst** · Broadridge Financial Solutions · Andover, MA · Jan 2014 – Jun 2024

*Forty-plus enterprise SaaS client onboardings end-to-end in compliance-grade financial services, where a wrong output had regulatory consequence rather than a care ticket.*

- **Led 40+ enterprise SaaS client onboardings from contract through first successful production run.** Owned the activation arc that determined whether customers stayed and grew. Partnered with engineering on system behavior, data flows, and integration dependencies; partnered with services and customer-facing teams on workflows non-technical buyers could operate without support.
- **Served as internal subject-matter expert for an omni-channel communication product adopted across the entire enterprise client base**, translating complex compliance capabilities into customer-facing workflows. Designed and refined intake and delivery processes that reduced rework cycles and improved time-to-first-value.

**Senior Document Development Analyst** · Broadridge Financial Solutions · Andover, MA · Jan 2006 – Jan 2014

*Built and maintained complex client-facing document and communication systems in a regulated financial services environment.*

## SKILLS AND FOCUS AREAS

**Onboarding & Activation:** End-to-end onboarding system design across product, services, and operations; activation metrics ownership (pNPS, time-to-first-value, activation rate, care ticket volume, early retention); CX-mindset across customer-facing and internal tooling; intake-process design and continuous improvement; multi-product configuration orchestration

**AI as Core Multiplier:** AI capability platform building, agentic AI as first-class product feature, AI-native product work (prototyping, analysis, iteration in Claude Code), twenty custom slash commands and a personal Claude Code productivity OS in active daily use, MCP-based integrations, agentic workflow design, AI adoption measurement (extinction over addition)

**Product Strategy & Leadership:** Senior product management scope, product vision and roadmap, OKR-to-execution, prioritization in ambiguous spaces, cross-functional leadership without direct authority, mentorship of PMs, outcomes over output, Agile / Scrum, B2B SaaS

**Data & Experimentation:** Opinionated analytics products, composite scoring and risk modeling, success-metric and KPI definition, hypothesis-driven development, signal-versus-noise routing

**Technical Credibility:** APIs and integrations, system architecture, data flows and integration dependencies, deployment-model and platform product thinking, technical-systems fluency with engineering, scoping directly with platform architects, SQL

**Enterprise SaaS:** Compliance-grade regulated delivery, client confidentiality as table stakes, enterprise customer escalation-room presence, multi-org program coordination, stakeholder management

**Tooling:** Jira, Confluence, GitHub, SQL, Claude Code CLI, Slack MCP, Salesforce Service Cloud (operator)

## EDUCATION

**Bachelor of Science, Management Information Systems and Management**

Manning School of Business, UMass Lowell · 1999

## WRITING AND THOUGHT LEADERSHIP

**The Unofficial Leader** (Substack) · [theunofficialleader.substack.com](https://theunofficialleader.substack.com)

Weekly publication on AI adoption realism, what activation actually compounds into, and where agentic systems earn their place. Originator of the Zero-Translation Building framework.